



Christmas Time Again

Changes to the medical definition for Transient Ischaemic Attack (TIA) and what this means to claims

Agenda

ABI Stroke Definitions

Old definition for Transient Ischaemic Attack

Revised definition of Transient Ischaemic Attack

Implications for claims

Case Study

Questions

ABI Stroke Definitions

1999 - 2006

Stroke

A cerebrovascular incident resulting in permanent neurological damage. Transient ischaemic attacks are specifically excluded

2006 - 2011

Stroke – Resulting in permanent symptoms

Death of brain tissue due to inadequate blood supply or haemorrhage within the skull resulting in permanent neurological deficit with persisting clinical symptoms.

For the above definition, the following are not covered:

- Transient ischaemic attack
- Traumatic injury to brain tissue or blood vessels

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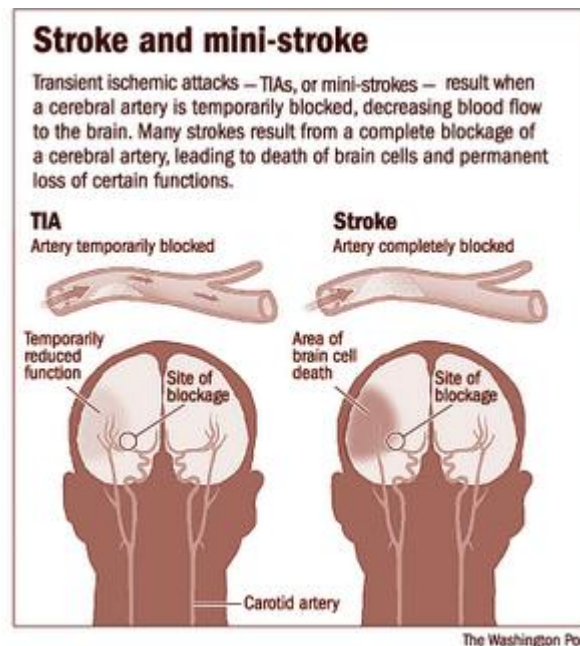
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Old definition for Transient Ischaemic Attack

A TIA is a sudden, focal, neurological deficit of presumed vascular origin, lasting less than 24 hours



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Revised definition for Transient Ischaemic Attacks

Stroke

JOURNAL OF THE AMERICAN HEART ASSOCIATION

American Stroke
AssociationSM

A Division of American
Heart Association



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<http://stroke.ahajournals.org/content/40/6/2276>

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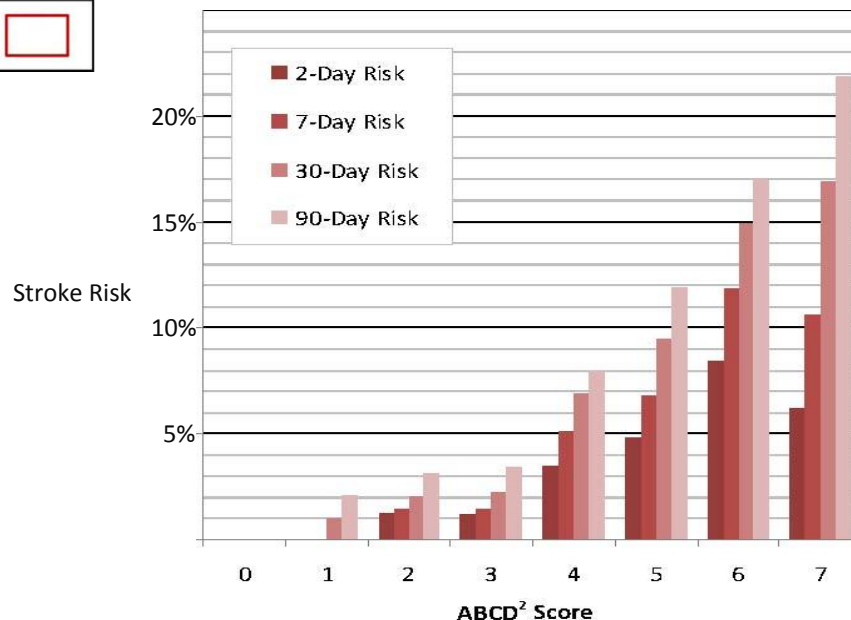
Revised definition for Transient Ischaemic Attacks

Transient Ischaemic Attack (TIA): A transient episode of neurological dysfunction caused by focal brain, spinal cord or retinal ischaemia, without acute infarction

Risk of stroke following a TIA

Risk Factor	Points	Score
Age ≥ 60 years	1	☐
Blood pressure Systolic BP ≥ 140 mm Hg OR Diastolic BP ≥ 90 mm Hg	1	☐
Clinical features of TIA (<i>choose one</i>) Unilateral weakness with or without speech impairment OR Speech impairment without unilateral weakness	2 1	☐
Duration TIA duration ≥ 60 minutes TIA duration 10-59 minutes	2 1	☐
Diabetes	1	☐
Total ABCD² score	0-7	☐

ABCD ₂ Score	2-day Stroke Risk	Comment
0-3	1.0%	Hospital observation may be unnecessary without another indication (e.g., new atrial fibrillation)
4-5	4.1%	Hospital observation justified in most situations
6-7	8.1%	Hospital observation worthwhile



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Claim Condition	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010
Cancer	59%	59%	60%	61%	61%	61%
Heart Attack	14%	14%	11%	11%	10%	10%
Stroke	6%	6%	6%	7%	7%	7%
MS	6%	6%	6%	6%	5%	6%

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- Male
- Age 55
- Ex-Smoker
- 6 units per week
- BMI 25

Stroke: -

Cerebrovascular incident resulting in permanent neurological damage

Transient ischaemic attacks are specifically excluded

- Claimant attended hospital with intermittent right occipital headaches on 4 or 5 occasions lasting no more than 2 hours. Admitted to occasional dizzy spells, feeling light-headed and blurred vision over past 2 years also
- Symptoms of basilar ischaemia consistent with a TIA, but he does have an infarct on the right > left pons
- Because the imaging was done over 3 weeks after symptoms onset, it was not surprising his DWI was negative. However, it is impossible to accurately date the duration of his right pontine infarction on MRI at this stage
- He had a TIA with imaging evidence of infarction on brain MRI. He did not have a 'clinical stroke syndrome' that lasted > 24 hours, but the definition of TIA and stroke on clinical Vs imaging grounds is the subject of debate at present

